** Richard Fkk. 'The Social Organisation in North-East India in Buddha's Time' (Calcutta,*

1920), p. 286. A more recent book, chiefly based on the Jataka stories, is Ratilal Mehta's

' Pre-Buddhist India' (Bombay, 1939). I am indebted to this latter book for most of my facts.

an extensive scale. Gardens and parks were common, and fruits and flowers were valued. The list of flowers mentioned is a long one; among the favourite fruits were the mango, fig, grape, plantain and the date. There were evidently many shops of vegetable and fruit sellers in the cities, as well as of florists. The flower-garland was then, as now, a favourite of the Indian people.

Hunting was a regular occupation chiefly for the food it provided. Flesh-eating was common and included poultry and fish; venison was highly esteemed. There were fisheries and slaughter-houses. The principal articles of diet were, however, rice, wheat, millet and corn. Sugar was extracted from sugar-cane. Milk and its varioys products were then, as they are now, highly prized. There were liquor shops, and liquor was apparently made from